

The example above illustrated unconscious purchases of a very moderate spender.

Now let's take out that financial Ouija board and call up some real bloodcurdling Ghost Money created by a really big unconscious spender over the course of twenty years—someone who complains he never has enough money at the end of the month, yet there he is, lining up for his fancy coffee four times a week, saying he's too busy to make his own lunch and take it to work. Oh, and now he drinks a couple of beers every night, because “social drinking” moved from the restaurant bar to the living room sofa a long time ago. He commutes by public transit, but he buys a lot of glossy magazines off the rack for something to read every day. Not only does he spend constantly and unconsciously, he spends like this for *decades*. This is his approximate Ghost Money over twenty years of habitual, incidental, noncrucial spending, with compounded interest set at a more realistic 6 percent—which, in fact, has been the forty-year interest rate average. (This also assumes the base price never goes up, and we all know that's not the case with alcohol.)

		SUBTOTAL	6% INTEREST (Rounded Off)	TOTAL
Coffee	\$12/week for 20 years	12,480	11,820	24,300
Magazines	\$8/week for 20 years	8,320	7,900	16,220
Lunch	\$200/month for 20 years	48,000	45,600	93,600
Alcohol	\$10/day for 20 years	73,000	69,300	142,300
Grand Total		141,800	134,620	276,420

So what does our big unconscious spender have to show for all these purchases? A grand total of \$276,420 in Ghost Money. Gone. Instead of putting that money into an account that accrued interest, this person bought *People* every week. Instead of saving for retirement, he enjoyed half-caf mochaccinos many mornings. Big money rarely dies